MyLearna Education

Name: _____

Date: _____

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

High School Foundations | Unit 8

Suffix -ate

Today I am learning that the suffix -ate often forms verbs naming an action or process.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix -ate often forms verbs that name an action or process. In academic and technical vocabulary, it can connect a verb with a related noun or adjective. Not every word ending in -ate contains this suffix, so use a related base or word family as a clue.

activate
make active

validate
confirm as valid

motivate
give a motive or reason

originate
begin from an origin

2 Build the Word

Use a base or related word and the suffix -ate to build the derived verb. Some related words change slightly.

Base / related	Suffix	New verb	Meaning clue
active	-ate		
valid	-ate		
motive	-ate		
origin	-ate		
regular	-ate		

3 Read and Notice

During a renewable-energy investigation, students had to calculate how much electricity each solar panel produced and validate their results by repeating the measurements. They used sensors to regulate the flow of power and activate a warning light whenever the battery reached its limit. Accurate records helped the group compare results and communicate what had changed between trials.

Later, the class worked on a model greenhouse. They programmed a controller to regulate temperature, circulate air and activate a small irrigation pump when the soil became dry. Before presenting the project, each team had to formulate a clear explanation of its design and evaluate whether the system had met its goals. The teacher asked students to justify each change with evidence rather than guesswork.

The class then compared several related word families. They linked active with activate, valid with validate, motive with motivate and origin with originate. They noticed that the spelling relationship is not always a simple letter-by-letter addition, but the related words still share meaning.

By the end of the lesson, students could see that many academic verbs ending in -ate name an action or process. Looking for a related base or word family helped them interpret unfamiliar vocabulary and decide whether -ate was functioning as a suffix rather than simply appearing

Highlight the -ate verbs. Underline a base or related word clue when you can, then decide whether -ate is functioning as a suffix.

4 Word Detective

Choose one -ate word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

a. Write an -ate word from the passage.

b. What base or related word can you identify?

c. What action or process does the verb name?

d. Is -ate functioning as a suffix here? Explain.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by whether -ate is a suffix or simply part of the word ending.

activate	validate	regulate	motivate
climate	pirate	senate	chocolate

Has suffix -ate	Letters -ate only

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

a. To validate a conclusion, a researcher should

b. Use activate, regulate or motivate in a sentence that shows its meaning.

Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises -ate as a verb-forming suffix
- ☐ Identifies a base or related word
- ☐ Distinguishes a suffix from a letter ending
- ☐ Reads and uses derived verbs accurately in context

Capture idea:

Find an -ate verb in a science, history or information text. Record the word, identify a related base or word family, and explain what